
EDUCATION

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY, School of International and Public Affairs (SIPA)

New York, NY

Master of International Affairs, Data Science for Policy (DSP) concentration

December 2026

Capstone: From Data to Action: Understanding Forced Labour Drivers, International Labour Organization (Geneva, Switzerland)

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences (GSAS)

Master of Arts, Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences (QMSS), Data Science focus

NEW YORK UNIVERSITY, College of Arts and Sciences

New York, NY

Bachelor of Arts, Double Major in International Relations & Public Policy (Honors Distinction)

May 2024

Region: Spain/European Union & Middle East & North Africa (MENA)

Awards: Dean's List (2021-2023), Horace Wendorf Scholarship (2023), Dean's Undergraduate Research Grant (2023)

Study Abroad: NYU Madrid, Madrid Spain (August - December 2022)

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Communities Speak, Columbia University, SIPA

New York, NY

Quantitative Research Assistant

January - September 2025

- Rebuilt data pipeline architecture from extraction through presentation, enhancing processing efficiency and analytical capabilities.
- Spearheaded design and dissemination of Spring 2025 Food Security module survey, establishing methodological framework and scaling data collection across target populations.
- Integrated geospatial analysis system within analytical approach, establishing a Google API for geocoding, creating R functions for replicability, and composing detailed QGIS instructions for future use.

Invest NYC SDG, NYU Stern Center for Sustainable Business (CSB)

New York, NY

Administration, Research Assistant

January 2021 - May 2024

- Mastered complex Salesforce and Formstack platforms, then designed and authored a comprehensive 35+ page implementation guide that became the foundation for the initiative's data management infrastructure.
- Trained director and associate directors on front-end data entry, ensuring consistent system adoption across teams.
- Executed field research for two multi-million-dollar food security initiatives (FoodMap NY and M.A.P. NYC), producing insights that informed policy recommendations for NYC's five boroughs.

Ralph Bunche Summer Institute, Duke University, American Political Science Association (APSA)

Durham, NC

RBSI Fellow

May - July 2023

- Authored a 30-page research paper analyzing the relationship between academic freedom, regime type and number of publications and patents over time, using multiple regression and time-series statistical models in R with V-Dem data.

PUBLICATIONS

Sanchez S. and Di Gennaro Splendore L. "Untangling the Relationship Between Democracy, Data, and Development: A Dynamic Two-Stage Analysis of the Sustainable Development Goals." 2026. Unpublished manuscript, submitted for publication.

Sanchez, Sevastian. "When National Statistics Die, Democracy Dies With Them." The Morningside Post, 26 Feb. 2026, <https://morningsidepost.com/articles/2026/2/26/when-national-statistics-die-democracy-dies-with-them>.

Sanchez, Sevastian. "Legal Obstacles to Food Security Efforts: The Central New York Regional Market Authority." *Invest NYC SDG: What We're Learning*, NYU Stern Center for Sustainable Business, 2 Nov. 2023, <https://www.stern.nyu.edu/experience-stern/about/departments-centers-initiatives/centers-of-research/center-sustainable-business/research/research-initiatives/invest-nyc-sdg-initiative/news/legal-obstacles-food-security-efforts-central-new-york-regional-market-authority>.

Sanchez S. and Robinson I.C. "NYC Transit Bus Infrastructure and Inequities in Particulate Matter (PM) Exposures Impacting Demographic Minorities." 49th Annual Undergraduate Research Conference (URC), 5 May 2023, New York University, New York, NY. Poster Presentation.
<https://cas.nyu.edu/content/dam/nyu-as/cas/documents/inquiry/xxvii.pdf>, *Inquiry* pp-57.

PROJECTS

QMSS Master Thesis: Data Deterioration & Democratic Erosion

New York, NY

January - August 2025

Statistical Casualties of Autocratization: Mapping Data Deterioration and SDG Progress

- Designed study that examines causal pathways between democratic backsliding, statistical capacity deterioration, and SDG performance across 170+ countries (2016-2023).
- Implemented advanced econometric techniques in R including dynamic two-way fixed effects (TWFE) and first-difference models to isolate immediate and incremental effects while controlling for unobserved confounders.
- Constructed comprehensive data pipeline, sourcing World Bank SPI, UN SDG Index, and EIU Democracy Index from APIs, before cleaning then wrangling for initial analyses.
- Conducted rigorous model diagnostics including Ramsey RESET and Breusch-Pagan heteroskedasticity tests while managing systematic missing data patterns across cross-sectional dimensions.

Independent Study: Air Quality Inequities in NYC Public Transit

New York, NY

January 2023 - May 2024

Employing Air Quality Detection Tools to Investigate Particulate Matter (PM) Inequities - presented at NYU's 49th and 50th Undergraduate Research Conference (URC)

- Led multidisciplinary research team through weekly coordination, completing data collection protocols across three NYC transit routes.
- Secured the Dean Undergraduate Research Grant, used for purchasing portable air-quality detectors that captured average PM exposure of bus and subway commuters.
- Introduced research at NYU's 49th and 50th Undergraduate Research Conferences, earning recognition as the 2023 Horace Wendorf Research Scholar.

NYU Honors Thesis: Localizing The UN SDG Framework in the United States

New York, NY

January - August 2025

Establishing Means of Mobilization: Expanding National Reporting Capacity to Localize the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals in the United States

- Evaluated policy commitment across all OECD member countries using a 7-indicator framework, revealing critical gaps in U.S. SDG localization efforts and informing policy advocacy recommendations.
- Proposed the expansion of disaggregated data reporting to better advocate for SDG policy.
- Awarded honors distinction in recognition of the strength of thesis defense and paper.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Research Certifications: CITI Social and Behavioral Research; CITI Human Subjects Protection SBR; CITI Responsible Conduct of Research (RCR).

Software: R (tidyverse, plm, lmttest, tmap), Python (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, Seaborn), D3.js, GitHub, Markdown, PostgreSQL, SDMX, Salesforce, QGIS, ArcGIS, Geoda, EJSscreen, Microsoft Office, Google Suite.

Language: English (Native), Spanish (Fluent), French (Conversational).